SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #9 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

# “Everyone from that group is the same.”

✦ ✦ ✦

## Where it often comes from

Stereotypes are learned early: from family jokes, news coverage, a bad experience, or a neighborhood’s attitudes. Our minds sort people into categories to save effort, and fear or hurt can harden those categories. The result is judging individuals by a label.

## What Scripture teaches

God told Samuel, “Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart,” and Peter learned that God shows no favoritism. James writes, “do not show favoritism.” Genesis teaches, “God created man in His own image… male and female He created them.” Jesus welcomed a Samaritan woman and held up a Samaritan as the hero of a story; the Samaritan “had compassion.” Scripture insists that every person is an individual made in God’s image. Labels flatten what God made unique.

> *“My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism”* (James 2:1).

## Also see

> “So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them” (Genesis 1:27).

> “But when a Samaritan on a journey came upon him, he looked at him and had compassion” (Luke 10:33).

> “Here there is no Greek or Jew, circumcised or uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave, or free, but Christ is all and is in all” (Colossians 3:11).

> “From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands” (Acts 17:26).

## Common self-statements

- They are all alike.
- You can’t trust any of them.
- I know what those people are like.
- One bad experience tells me everything.
- They are all the same.
- I do not need to know them.

## Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating one person or experience as representing a group.
- Labeling: Reducing individuals to a category.
- Confirmation bias: Noticing only what fits the stereotype.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know what an individual thinks.

## Challenging questions

- Where did I first learn this idea about this group?

- Do I know anyone from this group personally? What are they like?
- Would I want someone to judge me by a label?
- What exceptions have I noticed, and what does that suggest?
- What does it mean that every person is made in God's image?
- How could I get to know one person as an individual?

## Truth summary

> Every person is made in God's image and is an individual. Labels hide the person God sees. I can examine my assumptions, listen, and treat people one by one.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prejudice
- Judgmental
- Love, For Others
- Humility
- Pride

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Judgmental
- Love

## Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "Everyone from that group is the same"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"Everyone from that group is the same." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ Where did I learn this?
- ☐ Whom do I know from this group?
- ☐ Would I want a label?
- ☐ What exceptions do I see?
- ☐ What does image of God mean?
- ☐ Whom can I meet?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ Every person is made in God's image.
- ☐ God does not show favoritism.
- ☐ Labels hide individuals.
- ☐ Exceptions are not rare, they are the rule.
- ☐ Compassion crosses boundaries.
- ☐ I can listen and learn.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ James 2:1
  *"My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism."*
- ☐ Genesis 1:27
  *"So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."*
- ☐ Luke 10:33
  *"But when a Samaritan on a journey came upon him, he looked at him and had compassion."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ One person at a time: Each week, note one assumption you questioned and what you learned.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  *For example, James 2:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Every person is made in God's image, so I will not judge by a label.""*
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Prejudice" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.*

- ☐ Name the stereotype. Write what you think of the group and where it came from.
- ☐ Test it. Look for counterexamples in your own experience.
- ☐ Meet one person. Ask someone from the group about their life.
- ☐ Pray for the group. Pray by name for people you know.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Everyone from that group is the same": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | An assumption questioned |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Everyone from that group is the same.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, forgive me for the ways I have lumped people together. Help me see each person as You see them, made in Your image, and let me love my neighbor with open eyes. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*